DPP	DEPARTMENT POLICY AND PROCEDURE		
Title	**STANDARD OF NURSING PRACTICE**		
Department	**Intensive Care Unit**		
Applies to	**All ICU Nursing Staff**		
Policy Code and Version Number	**DPP-ICU-030 (v3)**		
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18 / 11 / 2025	2 / 12 / 2025	TRIENNIAL	17 / 11 / 2028

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1.0 PURPOSE

1.1. To serve as guidelines in providing and evaluating nursing care.

1.2. To enhance awareness of all nursing staff in all categories (in the unit) on the scope of safe nursing practice that conforms to the International Standards.

1.3. To serve as guide for the nursing leadership to evaluate safe and effective nursing care as well as to determine when nursing practice is below the expected standard of practice/care.

2.0 DEFINITION/ABBREVIATION

2.1. **Standard** – is the desired and achievable level of performance against which actual practice is compared

2.2. **Policy** – is a document or statement that communicates a firm management decision regarding what is to be done in a given situation. Policies are generally designed to protect the welfare of patients/families, personnel and others

3.0 RESPONSIBILITY

3.1 **DON, ADON, Nursing Supervisor and Head Nurse** are responsible in the implementation of the effectiveness and monitoring each standard of practice in the area of care

4.0 POLICY

4.1. It is the policy of Mikhwa General Hospital Nursing Department that individual Nurse Practitioners act, govern and define the scope of nursing practice within the department and in different care areas.

5.0 PROCEDURE (S)

The following Standard of Practice will be implemented and monitored in the Nursing Department/Unit as follows:

5.1. **Standard of Professional Performance**

5.1.1. **Assessment**

5.1.1.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient collects relevant data pertinent to the patient's health or situation.

5.1.1.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.1.1.2.1. Data are collected from the patient, family, other healthcare providers and the community as appropriate to develop a holistic picture of the patient's needs.

5.1.1.2.2. The priority of data collection activities is driven by the patient's characteristics related to the immediate condition and anticipated needs.

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5.1.1.2.3. Pertinent and sufficient data are collected using appropriate evidence-based assessment techniques and instruments.

5.1.1.2.4. Analytical models and problem-solving tools are used.

5.1.1.2.5. Decision is made by matching formal knowledge with clinical findings.

5.1.1.2.6. Relevant data are documented.

5.1.1.2.7. Relevant data are communicated to other healthcare providers.

5.1.2. **Diagnosis**

5.1.2.1. The nurse caring for the acute and critically ill patient analyses the assessment data in determining diagnosis and care issues.

5.1.2.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.1.2.2.1. Diagnosis and care issues are derived from the assessment data.

5.1.2.2.2. Diagnosis and care issues are validated throughout the nursing interactions with the patient, family, other healthcare providers, and the community and across the healthcare system when possible and appropriate.

5.1.2.2.3. Diagnosis and care issues are prioritizing and documented in a manner that facilitates prioritizing outcomes and developing or modifying the plan.

5.1.3. **Outcome Identification**

5.1.3.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient identifies outcomes for the patient or the patient's situation.

5.1.3.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.1.3.2.1. Outcomes are derived from actual or potential diagnosis and care issues.

5.1.3.2.2. Outcomes are formulated in collaboration with the patient, family and other healthcare providers in relation to the level of participation in care and decision making.

5.1.3.2.3. Outcomes recognize, appreciate and incorporate differences.

5.1.3.2.4. Outcomes are attainable in relation to resources available; outcomes consider associated risks, benefits, current evidence, clinical expertise and cost.

5.1.3.2.5. Outcomes provide direction for continuity of care.

5.1.3.2.6. Outcomes include a target date for attainment.

5.1.3.2.7. Outcomes are modified on the basis of changes in patient characteristics or evaluation of the situation.

5.1.3.2.8. Outcomes are documented as measurable goals.

5.1.4. **Planning**

5.1.4.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient develops a plan that prescribes interventions to attain outcomes.

5.1.4.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.1.4.2.1. The plan is individualized and considers patient characteristics and the situation.

5.1.4.2.2. The plan is developed collaboratively with the patient, family and healthcare providers in a way that promotes each member's contribution toward achieving the outcomes.

5.1.4.2.2.1. The plan reflects current best evidence.

5.1.4.2.2.2. The plan provides for continuity of care, matching the nurse's competencies with the patient's characteristics.

5.1.4.2.2.3. The plan establishes priorities for care.

5.1.4.2.2.4. The plan includes strategies for promotion and restoration of health and prevention of further illness, injury and disease.

5.1.4.2.2.5. The plan considers economic impact and resources available.

5.1.5. **Implementation**

5.1.5.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient implements the plan coordinates care delivery and employs strategies to promote health.

5.1.5.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.1.5.2.1. Intervention is delivered in a manner that minimizes complications and life-threatening situation.

5.1.5.2.2. The patient and family participate in implementing the plan according to their level of participation and decision-making capabilities.

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5.1.5.2.3. Interventions are responsive to the uniqueness of the patient and family and create a compassionate and therapeutic environment, with the aim to promote comfort and prevent suffering.

5.1.5.2.4. The implemented plan and modification are documented.

5.1.5.2.5. Collaboration to implement the plan occurs with the patient, family, healthcare providers and healthcare system.

5.1.5.2.6. The plan facilitates learning for patient, families, nursing staff, other members of the healthcare team and the community including but not limited to health teaching, health promotion and disease management according to patient characteristic.

5.1.6. Evaluation

5.1.6.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient evaluates progress toward attaining outcomes.

5.1.6.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.1.6.2.1. Evaluation is systematic and ongoing using evidence-based techniques and instruments.

5.1.6.2.2. The team of patient, family and healthcare providers is involved in the evaluation process as appropriate.

5.1.6.2.3. Evaluation of the effectiveness of interventions toward achieving the desired outcome occurs.

5.1.6.2.4. Evaluation of the effectiveness of interventions toward achieving the desired outcome occurs.

5.1.6.2.5. Ongoing assessment data are used to revise the diagnosis, outcomes and plan as needed.

5.1.6.2.6. Results of the evaluation are documented.

5.2. Standard of Professional Performance

5.2.1. Quality of Practice

5.2.1.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient systematically evaluates and seeks to improve the quality and effectiveness of nursing practice.

5.2.1.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.2.1.2.1. The nurse participates in clinical inquiry through quality improvement activities.

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5.2.1.2.2. The nurse uses systems thinking to initiate changes in nursing practice and the healthcare delivery system.

5.2.1.2.3. The nurse ensures that quality improvement activities incorporate the patient's and family's beliefs, values and preferences as appropriate.

5.2.1.2.4. The nurse questions and evaluates practice in an ongoing process, providing informed practice and innovation through research and experimental learning.

5.2.1.2.5. The nurse identifies organizational systems barriers to quality care and patient outcomes.

5.2.1.2.6. The nurse collects data to monitor the quality and effectiveness of nursing practice.

5.2.1.2.7. The nurse develops, implements, evaluates and effectiveness of nursing practice.

5.2.2. **Professional Practice Evaluation**

5.2.2.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient evaluates his or her on nursing practice in relation to professional practice standards, institutional guidelines, relevant statutes, rules and regulations.

5.2.2.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.2.2.2.1. The nurse engages in a self-assessment and/or formal performance appraisal on a regular basis identifying areas of strength as well as areas where professional development would be beneficial.

5.2.2.2.2. The nurse seeks and reflects on constructive feedback regarding his or her own competencies from the team of patient, family and other healthcare provider.

5.2.2.2.3. The nurse takes action to achieve performance goals.

5.2.3. **Education**

5.2.3.1. The nurse acquires and maintains current knowledge and competency in the care of acutely and critically ill patient.

5.2.3.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.2.3.2.1. The nurse participates in ongoing learning activities to acquire and refine the knowledge and skills needed to care for acutely and critically ill patients and their families.

5.2.3.2.2. The nurse seeks learning opportunities that reflect evidence-based practice in order to maintain clinical skills and competencies needed to care for acutely and critically ill patients and families.

5.2.3.2.3. The nurse participates in ongoing learning activities related to professional practice.

5.2.3.2.4. The nurse maintains professional records that provide evidence of competency and life-long learning.

5.2.4. **Collegiality**

5.2.4.1. The nurse caring for acutely and critically ill patient interacts with and contributes to the professional development of peers and other healthcare providers as colleagues.

5.2.4.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.2.4.2.1. The nurse shares knowledge, skills and experiences with peers and colleagues.

5.2.4.2.2. The nurse provides peers and colleagues with constructive feedback regarding their practice.

5.2.4.2.3. The nurse interacts with peers and colleagues to enhance his or her own professional practice and promote optimal patient outcomes.

5.2.4.2.4. The nurse contributes to a supportive and healthy work environment that is conducive to the education of healthcare professionals.

5.2.4.2.5. The nurse contributes to a healthy work environment by working with others in a way that promotes mutual respect and meaningful recognition of each person's contribution.

5.2.5. **Ethics**

5.2.5.1. The nurse's decisions and actions are carried out in an ethical manner in all areas of practice.

5.2.5.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.2.5.2.1. The nurse maintains patient confidentiality within legal and regulatory parameters.

5.2.5.2.2. The nurse works on another's behalf and represents the concerns of patient, their families and the community.

5.2.5.2.3. The nurse delivers care in a non-judgemental and non-discriminatory manner that meets the diverse needs, strengths and

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weaknesses of the patient and preserves patient autonomy, dignity and right.

5.2.5.2.4. The nurse uses available resources in formulating ethical decision.

5.2.5.2.5. The nurse demonstrates a commitment to self-care and self-advocacy.

5.2.5.2.6. The nurse reports illegal, incompetent or impaired practice.

5.2.6. **Collaboration**

5.2.6.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient uses skilled communication to collaborate with the team of patient, family and healthcare providers in providing patient care in a safe, healing, humane and caring environment.

5.2.6.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.2.6.2.1. The nurse uses skilled communication to foster true collaboration.

5.2.6.2.2. The nurse partners with others to effect change and generate optimal outcomes through knowledge of the patient or situation.

5.2.6.2.3. The nurse commits on establishing and maintaining a healthy work environment.

5.2.6.2.4. The nurse initiates referrals as appropriate to promote continuity of care.

5.2.6.2.5. The nurse collaborates with the patient's family and significant others to promote effective transition across care settings.

5.2.7. **Research/ Clinical Inquiry**

5.2.7.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient uses clinical inquiry and integrates research findings into practice.

5.2.7.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.2.7.2.1. The nurse continually questions and evaluates practice and uses the best available evidence including research findings to guide practice decisions.

5.2.7.2.2. The nurse participates in activities to support clinical inquiry as appropriate to the nurse's skill, knowledge and experience.

5.2.8. **Resource Utilization**

5.2.8.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient considers factors related to safety, effectiveness, cost and impact in planning and delivering nursing services.

5.2.8.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.2.8.2.1. The nurse considers factors related to safety, effectiveness, availability, cost and impact in on outcomes when choosing among practice options.

5.2.8.2.2. The nurse assists the patient and family in identifying and securing appropriate and available services to address health-related needs according to resource availability.

5.2.8.2.3. The nurse assign or delegates aspect of care, based upon an assessment of the needs and condition of patient, the potential for harm, the stability of the patient's condition, the predictability of the outcome, the availability and competence of the healthcare provider and the availability of resources.

5.2.8.2.4. The nurse assists the patient and family to become informed consumers by facilitating learning of the option, alternatives, risks, benefits and cost for treatment and care.

5.2.9. **Leadership**

5.2.9.1. The nurse caring for the acutely and critically ill patient provides leadership in the professional practice setting as well as the profession.

5.2.9.2. Measurement Criteria:

5.2.9.2.1. The nurse encouraged peers and colleagues through mentoring and other strategies.

5.2.9.2.2. The nurse demonstrates flexibility and the ability to remain patient-focused in a rapidly changing environment.

5.2.9.2.3. The nurse directs the coordination of care across the continuum and among caregivers, including oversight of licensed and unlicensed personnel in any assigned or delegated tasks.

5.2.9.2.4. The nurse participates on committee, councils and administrative teams.

5.2.9.2.5. The nurse promotes advancement of the profession through participation in professional organizations.

5.2.9.2.6. The nurse promotes communication of information and advancement of the profession through writing, publishing and presentations for professional and lay audiences.

5.2.9.2.7. The nurse uses an oven systematic methodology in the development and implementation of innovative solutions.

6.0 EQUIPMENTS

6.1. N/A

7.0 ATTACHMENT/FORMS

7.1. N/A

8.0 REFERENCES

8.1. American Nurses Association. Nursing: Scope and Standard of Practice Washington, DC: American Nurses Association; 2004

8.2. MOH Manual of Nursing Policy and Procedures 2nd Edition 2011

8.3. 2008 American Association of Critical-Care Nurses

8.4. American Nurses Association. Code of Ethics for Nurses with Interpretive Statements Washington, DC: American Nurses Association; 2001

9.0 REVISION CLAUSE

9.1. Used the new logo for AL-Baha Health Cluster.

9.2. Modify the policy and procedure lay out, changed the content of the Header and footer

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